

IN BETWEEN LISBON AND PORTO



BLU COSTA
Travel Curation

Journeys on the Land

In Between Lisbon and Porto

Blu Journey No. 204

Edition No. 03/2026

Luxury isn't always
what you expect.

Sometimes it's an oyster pulled from cold water.

A cave that stops you mid-sentence.

A valley that asks nothing of you.



Contents

Blu Costa — The House of Travel Curation	05
A few favorite corners	13
In Between Lisbon and Porto	28
The practical side of travel	31
Contact	57

The House

*Travel is not accumulation.
It is interpretation.*

*We choose depth,
context,
presence.*

*Luxury, to us, is time.
Time to arrive, to understand, to feel.*

*We curate journeys that make sense
and stay with you.*

*Blu Costa
The House of Travel Curation*

The People Behind Blu

*Born and raised in Lisbon, **Tiago** brings a historian's and architect's eye to every journey.*

***Adriana**, a world travel journalist, brings a storyteller's sensibility to the details that matter.*

Together, we curate journeys across Portugal and Spain, designed not simply to see more, but to understand each place more fully.

We look forward to interpreting yours.

Adriana and Tiago



How We Curate

Every journey begins by understanding pace
and what should remain.

We do not assemble trips.
We interpret them.

Curation is the discipline of choosing what
belongs and shaping how moments connect.

Our work moves through five lenses:

Journeys in Cities
Journeys on the Land
Journeys by the Water
Journeys of Craft
Journeys in Time

Not categories of tourism,
but ways of shaping meaning.

How We Work with You

Every journey begins with a conversation.

We listen to understand what draws you to a place and how you prefer to travel.

Some travelers seek a single day well designed.

Others ask us to shape and accompany an entire journey.

From there, we select the places, encounters, and pacing that belong together.

Whether your ideas are clear or still taking form, our role is to interpret them.





From Adriana

Porto and the North of Portugal are places that stay with you long after you leave.

Authentic, soulful, and deeply rooted in tradition, this is a region where landscapes, flavors, and stories unfold at an unhurried, genuine pace.

To fully embrace the spirit of Porto and the North, we recommend allowing several days, ideally combining city life with the tranquility of the countryside.

This is a journey that reveals Portugal at its most genuine.

Adriana Lage

“

Óbidos is
a closed world,
a ship of stone
anchored on a hill.

”

— José Saramago, Portuguese writer



A few favorite
corners on the
road to inspire
you.





1788

ÓBIDOS

Óbidos feels like a storybook brought to life, where medieval walls embrace whitewashed houses and centuries of history unfold at every turn.

As you wander its cobbled streets, tradition, craftsmanship, and quiet beauty reveal themselves in small, meaningful details.

From the ramparts, the surrounding landscape opens across fields and distant hills, extending beyond the walls into a broader rural setting.

Why it stays with you

Medieval atmosphere

A sense of timelessness

An unhurried rhythm



MIRA DE AIRE

The Mira de Aire Caves are among Portugal's most impressive natural sites, revealing a vast underground world of stalactites and stalagmites.

Carefully designed walkways and lighting make the caves easy to explore and very accessible for visitors of all ages.

Descending through chambers and rock formations offers a striking contrast to the landscape above.

Why it stays with you

Natural formations

High accessibility

Easy exploration



ALCOBAÇA MONASTERY

One of Portugal's most important Gothic landmarks and a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

Founded in the 12th century, it reflects the power and influence of the Cistercian order. Its vast interior and pure architectural lines create a striking sense of scale and simplicity.

It is also home to the iconic tombs of Pedro and Inês, one of Portugal's most enduring love stories.

Within its monastic life, conventual sweets emerged, forming a lasting culinary tradition.

Why it stays with you

UNESCO heritage

Portuguese Romeo & Juliet love story

Traditional conventual desserts

Beauty lives in stone,
light, and
the patience of time.



BATALHA MONASTERY

The Monastery of Batalha is a masterpiece of Gothic and Manueline architecture and a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

Built to commemorate a decisive moment in Portugal's history, it stands as a symbol of national identity and ambition.

Intricate stonework, soaring arches, and the Unfinished Chapels reveal remarkable artistic detail. A visit offers insight into the country's history, architecture, and craftsmanship.

Why it stays with you

UNESCO heritage

Unique Portuguese architecture

National symbolism



COIMBRA

Coimbra is a city shaped by knowledge, tradition, and centuries of academic life. Home to one of Europe's oldest universities, its historic center rises above the Mondego River in layered streets and courtyards.

Libraries, chapels, and student rituals reflect a culture deeply rooted in learning and ceremony.

At the same time, everyday life flows naturally through cafés, squares, and riverside paths.

Why it stays with you

Historic university

Scholarly soul

Quiet character



AVEIRO

Often called the “Venice of Portugal,” Aveiro charms with its calm canals, colorful moliceiro boats, and elegant Art Nouveau façades.

Shaped by the lagoon and the sea, the city has a light, relaxed rhythm that invites unhurried exploration.

Traditional salt pans and maritime heritage still influence local life and flavors. Aveiro is a graceful blend of water, architecture, and quiet coastal charm.

Why it stays with you

Canals and boats

Art Nouveau

Pretty coastline

“

The canals of
Aveiro
are the veins
of a silent heart.

”

— Fernando Pessoa, Portuguese poet



PORTO

Porto is a city of character, shaped by the Douro River and centuries of trade, tradition, and resilience.

Its historic center unfolds through layered streets, tiled façades, and riverfront scenes full of life. Wine cellars, bridges, and viewpoints reveal a city both hardworking and poetic.

Its gastronomy, culture, and everyday rhythms feel genuine and unpretentious, a place that rewards curiosity and invites you to linger.

Why it stays with you

Authentic atmosphere

Historic riverfront

World-class wine

“

Porto is a city that knows
the value of a promise
and the weight of a glass
of Port.

”

— Eça de Queirós, Portuguese writer

IN BETWEEN LISBON AND PORTO



Suggested
Journeys

Journey Interpretations

This journey may be experienced in three distinct ways. Each offers a different degree of depth, pace and access.

The Natural Landscape

A journey through landscape, coastline, and open space.

Portugal in Time

The route north brings together locations that speak to Portugal's history and identity.

In Layers

A journey through layers of landscape, knowledge, and making.



Portugal in Time

The route north brings together locations that speak to Portugal's history and identity.

Within Walls

Encircled by medieval walls, Óbidos preserves narrow streets, whitewashed houses, and a townscape that offers a glimpse into centuries of Portuguese history.

The Lagoon City

Along the lagoon of Aveiro, canals, colorful moliceiro boats, and Art Nouveau façades illustrate a city shaped by water and maritime traditions.

Legacy in Porcelain

Founded in 1824, Vista Alegre carries generations of craftsmanship and artistic dedication within one of Portugal's most distinguished porcelain traditions.

Architecture of Intention

The Monastery of Batalha reflects a deliberate architectural vision and a symbol of political power, expressed through Gothic and Manueline forms.

Portugal in Time

08:30

The day begins towards Óbidos, “a closed world, a ship of stone anchored on a hill.” — José Saramago

Within its walls, daily life continues in a place where the past remains present in everyday life.

11:00

Leaving Óbidos, the road leads towards the coast, where the land gradually opens into light and water.

In Costa Nova, life by the water reflects a more recent layer of the country, where lunch is served by the water, between lagoon and sea.



Portugal in Time

AFTERNOON

The journey continues to the **Vista Alegre Factory**, where porcelain is produced within a long-standing tradition of craft and design.

In the museum, this work is presented through form, detail, and its development over time.

From Vista Alegre, we return to the water for a **moliceiro ride** along the canals of Aveiro.

17:30

From Aveiro, the journey continues north to Porto.

18:30

Arrival in Porto.

Portugal in Time

A MONASTIC DETOUR — Optional

Between Óbidos and Costa Nova, the journey may turn inland towards **Batalha**, with an earlier departure allowing time to visit the monastery.

At Batalha, the building holds a presence that goes beyond its form. Stone meets light, and in the Unfinished Chapels, the open sky suggests a work left intentionally incomplete.

Lunch is set at the foot of the monastery, before continuing to Vista Alegre, Aveiro, and Costa Nova on the way to Porto.

19:30

Arrival in Porto, where the day comes to rest.



In Layers

A journey through layers of landscape, knowledge, and making.

Beneath the Surface

At Mira de Aire, the caves reveal a subterranean landscape formed through water and stone. The path moves through chambers defined by scale and silence.

Knowledge in Depth

In Coimbra, the university stands as a foundation of knowledge. The Joanina Library reveals a deeper layer, set within a space reached beyond the visible.

Making in Layers

At a leather factory, craftsmanship reflects a high-end Portuguese industry of belts, bags, and shoes. Later, the museum traces its evolution from artisanal origins to 21st-century design.

In Layers

08:00

An early departure from Lisbon draws us inland.

In *Mira de Aire*, a descent leads into a vast subterranean world shaped over time. Chambers unfold below the surface, where stone, water, and stillness come together in unexpected scale and form.

11:00

Back in the light, the road leads north to Coimbra, where another layer awaits, with lunch at a traditional restaurant.



In Layers

AFTERNOON

The University of Coimbra anchors the city with a secular academic presence. A visit to the Joanina Library, with its richly worked interiors and centuries-old volumes, offers a glimpse into how knowledge has been guarded and valued over time.

16:30

Leaving Coimbra behind, we follow the road north to Porto.

18:00

Arrival in Porto, marking the end of the day.

In Layers

A DETOUR INTO CRAFT — Optional

Between Coimbra and Porto, the journey may take a detour towards the world of craft,

In a **leather workshop**, each piece is shaped with precision and care, followed by a visit to the **Shoe Museum**, where design reflects both tradition and continuity.

18:00

We take the road to Porto.

19:00

Arrival in Porto, marking the end of the day.

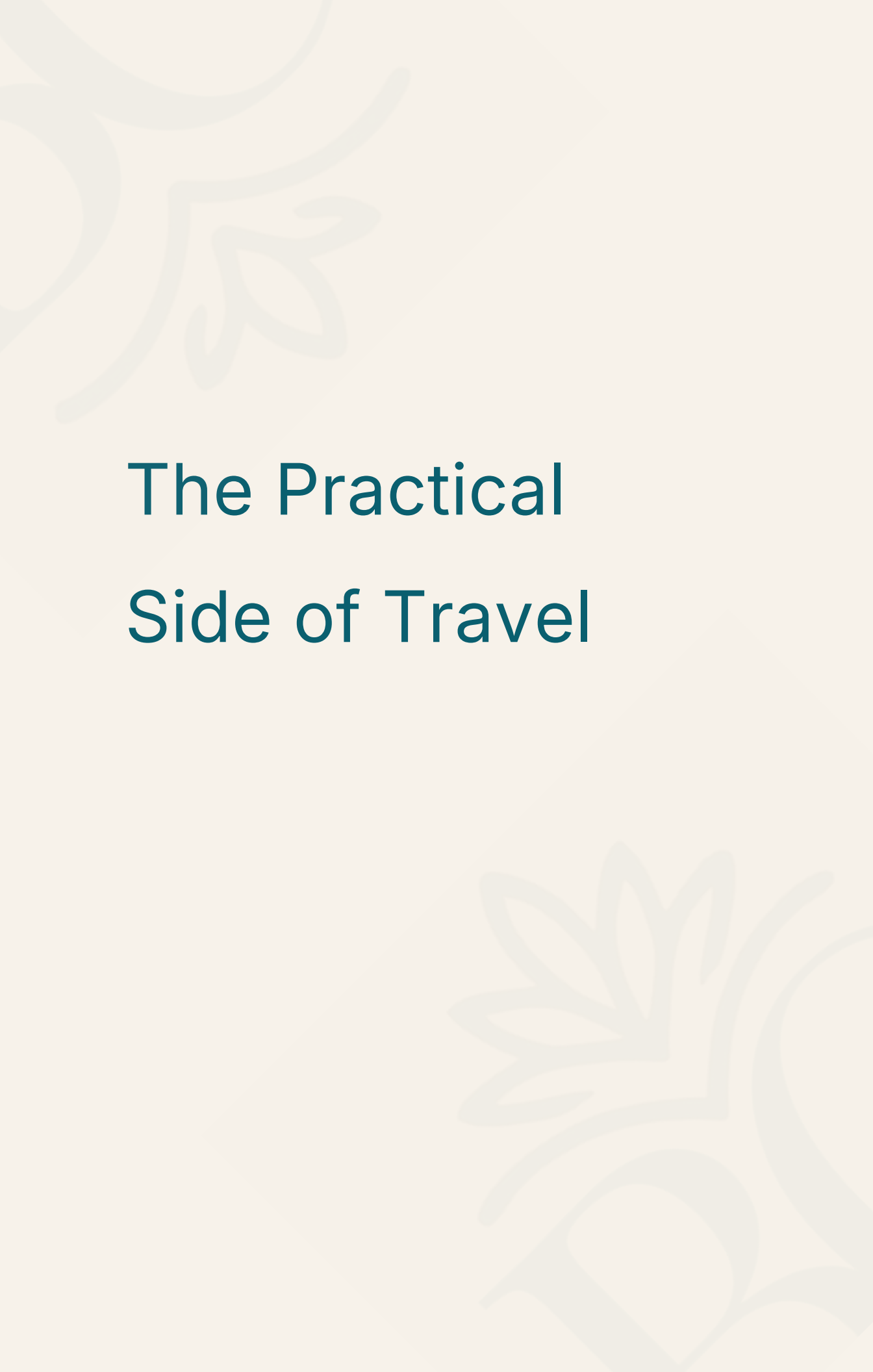


“

The traveler is the journey.
What we see is not what we see,
but who we are.

”

— José Saramago, Portuguese writer



The Practical Side of Travel

INVESTMENT

Based on 5 guests

Thoughtful inclusions in every journey

Private journey · Dedicated guide

Hotel pick-up and return · Guided visits

Portugal in Time

10h · € 1.330

A walk through Óbidos medieval town

Time for lunch in Costa Nova

Access to Vista Alegre Factory and Museum

Moliceiro ride in Aveiro

With A Monastic Detour

12h · € 1.560

A visit to the Batalha Monastery

A visit to the salt pans of Aveiro

6% VAT included

INVESTMENT

Based on 5 guests

Thoughtful inclusions in every journey

Private journey · Dedicated guide

Hotel pick-up and return · Guided visits

In Layers

9h · € 1.330

A descend to Mira de Aire caves

Time for lunch in Coimbra

A visit to the University of Coimbra and the Joanina Library

With A Monastic Detour

12h · € 1.560

A visit to a leather factory and the Shoe Museum

6% VAT included

ADDITIONAL TOUCHES

Handled Separately

Some personal items
are handled separately.

Travel insurance
Documents and visas
Flight tickets
Hotel reservations
Personal expenses
Gratuities

A Few Personal Choices

If, during the tour, you
feel like adding a visit to
an attraction or tasting
a few more wines, we'll
be happy to arrange it
along the way.

Any adjustments may
be settled at the end of
the tour.